

CCNA to DevOps

FOUR COURSES, ONE AFTER ANOTHER

From CCNA to a junior cloud or DevOps role

You already hold the part most DevOps candidates lack: networking. Four courses run back to back at 20 hours a week, each one finished before the next begins, with the resume updated and new job titles opened at the end of each. Eighteen weeks: three for SAA, two for Terraform, six for Decoding DevOps, four of buffer, portfolio and interview drills, three for KCNA with the exam on Feb 1. Tick sections as you finish them.

GOAL	job in January 2027	
START	09/28/2026	
SAA EXAM	by Oct 18	
DEVOPS DONE	Dec 13, 2026	
KCNA EXAM	Feb 1	
HOURS	20 a week	
RHYTHM	4 h on weekdays, weekends off	

AWS Solutions Architect Associate

TAKE, WEEK 3

The keyword recruiters filter on first. Book it in week 1.

Terraform Associate

SKIP

Not needed. The Terraform course plus a working VPC repo say more than the exam.

CKA

AFTER HIRE

Two to three months on its own. First six months on the job, employer usually pays.

KCNA

TAKE, FEB 1

Three weeks in January while applications are out, after a four-week buffer. Exam on Monday Feb 1. Course 4 below.

AWS BILL GUARD

Set a 20 dollar budget alert in week 1. NAT gateways, RDS, and EKS charge by the hour whether you use them or not. Destroy at the end of every session and check the billing page every Sunday.

FOR WHOEVER APPLIES

Applications start the week after the SAA result. Each course card carries an Apply during line and an Apply after line with the titles to use. Reject any posting that mentions

clearance, Secret, TS/SCI, US citizen, US person, Public Trust, ITAR or DoD 8570, and anything Senior, Lead, Principal, II, III or five-plus years. Require E-Verify. Prefer companies with H-1B filings in the last two years. W-2 contracts through an E-Verify staffing agency that signs the I-983 are fine, 1099 is not, and never a firm that charges for training or benches unpaid.

YOUR FOUR COURSES **What to take, and at what depth**

Full means normal speed with every lab typed by hand. Overview means one pass at 1.5x speed with no labs, so the tool means something when a job posting names it. Nothing is skipped. Each course starts the week the previous one ends. The safety valve is the four-week buffer in weeks 12 to 15: a slipped exam or project lands there, and the Feb 1 KCNA date holds.

Course 1 · Weeks 1 to 3 Sep 28 – Oct 18

AWS Certified Solutions Architect Associate (SAA-C03)

- ☐ **Week 1** Sep 28 – Oct 4 Getting started, IAM and AWS CLI, EC2 fundamentals, EC2 at SAA level, EC2 instance storage (EBS, EFS), high availability and scalability (ELB, ASG), RDS, Aurora, ElastiCache, Route 53, classic solutions architecture **FULL**
 - ☐ **Week 2** Oct 5 – Oct 11 S3, advanced S3, S3 security. CloudFront and Global Accelerator. Storage extras. Decoupling (SQS, SNS, Kinesis). Containers (ECS, Fargate, ECR, EKS). Serverless and serverless architectures. Databases in AWS. Monitoring. IAM advanced. Security and encryption **FULL**
 - ☐ **Week 2** Oct 5 – Oct 11 Data and analytics. Machine learning services **OVERVIEW**
 - ☐ **Week 3** Oct 12 – Oct 18 Networking VPC, fast with your CCNA. Disaster recovery and migrations. More solutions architecture. Well-Architected and whitepapers. Exam prep section. Then the included practice exam and Tutorials Dojo sets until three in a row score above 80 percent. Exam on the last day of the week **FULL**
 - ☐ **Week 3** Oct 12 – Oct 18 Other services section **OVERVIEW**
- 27 hours of video in three weeks at 20 hours a week is about 9 hours of lectures and 11 hours of labs, notes and practice exams per week. It is tight but it holds, and the practice-exam gate decides whether you sit on day 21 or day 28.
 - Book the exam in week 1 for the last day of week 3. If three practice exams are not above 80 percent by day 18, reschedule by one week, free of charge more than 24 hours ahead. The buffer in weeks 12 to 15 absorbs the shift. Do not sit it under 80.
 - Week 1 also rewrites the resume: headline Cloud / DevOps Engineer, credential strip CCNA and SAA exam scheduled, three-line summary, skills grouped by category, one page, no visa status.

RESUME Pass date and credential ID on the certification line. Cloud skills group with the services you can explain: VPC, EC2, S3, IAM, RDS, ELB, Route 53, CloudWatch, Lambda.

APPLY DURING None. Applications start the week after the result.

APPLY AFTER Cloud Support Associate at AWS. Cloud support engineer at managed service providers. Cloud engineer I, associate cloud engineer, cloud operations engineer, cloud network engineer. Network engineer I and NOC engineer as fallbacks. Associate cloud programs at Infosys, TCS, Cognizant, Accenture, Capgemini.

Course 2 · Weeks 4 to 5 Oct 19 – Nov 1

HashiCorp Terraform: The Ultimate Beginner's Guide with Labs

- ☐ **Week 4** Oct 19 – Oct 25 Days 1 to 3: IaC principles, installation, provider setup, CLI workflow (init, plan, apply, destroy, fmt, validate), resources, variables, outputs, locals, data sources, refactoring for DRY code, state, every lab **FULL**
- ☐ **Week 4** Oct 19 – Oct 25 Days 4 to 7: a two-AZ VPC module with public and private subnets, NAT gateways, route tables and security groups, in your own repo **FULL**
- ☐ **Week 5** Oct 26 – Nov 1 Days 1 and 2: remote state on an S3 backend with locking, and terraform import of one resource you made by hand in the console **FULL**
- ☐ **Week 5** Oct 26 – Nov 1 Days 3 to 5: refactor the VPC into a reusable module, consume one public Terraform Registry module and read its source, add tfint and terraform fmt as a pre-commit hook **FULL**
- ☐ **Week 5** Oct 26 – Nov 1 Days 6 and 7: README with an architecture diagram and a one-apply run guide. Destroy everything. This repo is project 0 on the resume **FULL**

- The course is about eight hours, so at 20 hours a week the second week is free for the portfolio work: remote state, a real module, a registry module, linting and a README are what separate a learner repo from an engineer repo.
- Type every lab yourself. Do not copy the finished code from the course repo.
- Destroy the NAT gateways when you stop for the day. They bill by the hour.

RESUME Terraform in an Infrastructure as Code skills group. The VPC module repo as the first project entry, with remote state and a registry module named in the bullets.

APPLY DURING The list from course 1 continues.

APPLY AFTER Add infrastructure automation engineer, cloud automation engineer, network automation engineer. Resend the resume with the VPC repo link.

Course 3 · Weeks 6 to 11 Nov 2 – Dec 13

Decoding DevOps, From Basics to Advanced Projects with AI

- ☐ [Week 6](#) Nov 2 – Nov 8 Linux and server management. Bash scripting. YAML and JSON. Python scripting basics [FULL](#)
- ☐ [Week 6](#) Nov 2 – Nov 8 Vagrant setup, you use EC2 instead. Networking fundamentals, your CCNA covers it [OVERVIEW](#)
- ☐ [Week 7](#) Nov 9 – Nov 15 Terraform (VPC, modules, backends), which becomes project 1 with an ALB, an Auto Scaling group and RDS added to your VPC module. Ansible, configure the instances with a playbook [FULL](#)
- ☐ [Week 7](#) Nov 9 – Nov 15 AWS Cloud section, one pass as SAA revision [OVERVIEW](#)
- ☐ [Week 8](#) Nov 16 – Nov 22 Docker. Python for automation and AWS tasks with Amazon Q. Security group audit script with boto3 [FULL](#)
- ☐ [Week 9](#) Nov 23 – Nov 29 Git. GitHub Actions, which becomes project 2, a pipeline to ECR and ECS Fargate with OIDC for an app of your own. Jenkins basics, one day [FULL](#)
- ☐ [Week 9](#) Nov 23 – Nov 29 Maven, GitLab CI, Nexus, SonarQube, Slack integration. AWS DevOps services: CodeCommit, CodeBuild, CodePipeline, Beanstalk, Lambda [OVERVIEW](#)
- ☐ [Week 10](#) Nov 30 – Dec 6 Kubernetes, all of it. Helm. Lens. Project 3: the app from project 2 on EKS through Terraform, with a Helm chart and an HPA [FULL](#)
- ☐ [Week 11](#) Dec 7 – Dec 13 Prometheus, Grafana, Alertmanager on the EKS cluster, one dashboard and one alert that fires. GitOps project with ArgoCD [FULL](#)
- ☐ [Week 11](#) Dec 7 – Dec 13 Loki and Alloy [OVERVIEW](#)

- The course sample app sits in hundreds of GitHub portfolios. Follow each course project once, then rebuild it for a different small app in your own repo with your own README.
- Use the AI assistants the course shows for speed, but be able to explain every line. Interviewers ask.
- Destroy RDS after week 7 and the EKS cluster after week 11. Check the bill.

RESUME Projects 1, 2 and 3 as job-style entries with GitHub links. Docker, Kubernetes, Helm, EKS in Containers. GitHub Actions and CI/CD in a CI/CD group. Ansible in IaC. Python (boto3) in Scripting. Prometheus, Grafana, CloudWatch in Monitoring.

APPLY DURING After project 1 goes live at the end of week 7: build and release engineer, junior DevOps engineer, DevOps engineer I, associate DevOps engineer. After project 2 at the end of week 9: DevOps engineer at companies under 500 people, platform engineer I. After project 3 at the end of week 10: junior Kubernetes engineer. Resend the resume each time.

APPLY AFTER All titles above. Resend the resume with the three repo links.

Buffer · Weeks 12 to 15 Dec 14 – Jan 10 **Catch-up and portfolio**

- ☐ Week 12 Dec 14 – Dec 20 Finish every unticked section above. Each of the four repos gets an architecture diagram, a how-to-run section and a design decisions paragraph. Pin them on your GitHub profile with a profile README that carries the credential strip **FULL**
 - ☐ Week 13 Dec 21 – Dec 27 Rebuild anything still copied from a course into your own app. Record a two-minute explanation of each project, listen back, record again. Resume keyword pass: DevOps, CI/CD, Infrastructure as Code, AWS, Terraform, Kubernetes, Docker, Linux, Python, monitoring, automation. Final resume to whoever applies for you **FULL**
 - ☐ Week 14 Dec 28 – Jan 3 Holiday week. One small commit per repo so the history is not frozen. Book the KCNA for Monday Feb 1. Confirm every AWS resource is destroyed and check the bill **FULL**
 - ☐ Week 15 Jan 4 – Jan 10 Interview drills on your own work: explain the VPC design, debug a failing pipeline, fix a crashing pod, write a Terraform module from memory, Linux and networking basics out loud. Mock interviews with a friend twice this week **FULL**
- Four weeks of slack. If the SAA exam or a project slipped, this is where it lands, and the KCNA date still holds.
 - If nothing slipped, week 15 is pure interview practice, which is worth more than starting KCNA early.

RESUME Final one-page pass. Cut objective statements, coursework lists and long Cisco feature lists. Keep education with degree and graduation date.

APPLY DURING All titles above. Hiring slows from Dec 20 to Jan 2. Keep sending, applications are read in the first week of January.

APPLY AFTER All titles above, with the final resume and four repo links.

Kubernetes and Cloud Native Associate (KCNA) Exam Course

- ☐ [Week 16](#) Jan 11 – Jan 17 Days 1 to 3: introduction, cloud native fundamentals and architecture (CNCf, personas, open standards, autoscaling, serverless, community and governance) [FULL](#)
 - ☐ [Week 16](#) Jan 11 – Jan 17 Day 3: Docker and containers from the ground up. You did Docker in week 8 [OVERVIEW](#)
 - ☐ [Week 16](#) Jan 11 – Jan 17 Days 4 and 5: Kubernetes fundamentals, first half, with the browser labs [FULL](#)
 - ☐ [Week 17](#) Jan 18 – Jan 24 Days 1 to 3: Kubernetes fundamentals to advanced, second half, every browser lab. Together the largest section, 46 percent of the exam [FULL](#)
 - ☐ [Week 17](#) Jan 18 – Jan 24 Days 4 and 5: container orchestration (CNI networking, CSI storage, CRI runtimes, security, service mesh) [FULL](#)
 - ☐ [Week 18](#) Jan 25 – Jan 31 Day 1: telemetry and observability, Prometheus and Grafana hands-on. Day 2: GitOps and application delivery with Argo CD, overview instead since you did the ArgoCD project in week 11 [FULL](#)
 - ☐ [Week 18](#) Jan 25 – Jan 31 Days 3 to 5: both practice exams, every wrong answer traced back to its lecture, killer.sh simulator if included, exam tips section. Exam on Monday Feb 1 [FULL](#)
- Three weeks for a ten-hour course means about four hours of lectures and labs on weekdays with no weekend work, and a full week of practice exams at the end.
 - Score above 80 percent on both course practice exams before you sit it.

RESUME KCNA on the certification line and Kubernetes in the credential strip the day you pass.

APPLY DURING Add site reliability engineer I, associate SRE, cloud platform engineer, with KCNA exam scheduled on the resume.

APPLY AFTER All titles. Resend the resume with KCNA on it the day you pass, Feb 1.